

Avery Lens

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Grant beside a shell-company shipping file.

What you are hiding

You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- You photographed Sterling and Grant beside a shipping file marked NORTHSTAR earlier in the evening.
- Theo chipped a cufflink against the Grand Gallery rail during Act I.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Your continuous photo sequence shows you shooting Imogen in the gallery during the key window.

IF MURDERER

You entered at 6:44 to negotiate, poisoned the cordial, and left a torn photo corner by the service table.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I kept a backup print after agreeing to delete a photograph Sterling wanted gone. That is the secret I was protecting. My own continuous photo sequence proves I was photographing Imogen in the gallery while the drink was poisoned.

IF MURDERER

Sterling wanted an image erased because it showed him beside a shipping file he could not explain. I went into the salon to bargain, poisoned his cordial when he refused, and tore the backup print in the struggle to leave cleanly. A photographer should know better than to leave evidence in the frame.

Investigation notes
